Nicolás de la Cerda

CONTACT INFORMATION

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APPOINTMENTS

University of New Mexico, Albuquerque, New Mexico
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science
2026-present
Faculty Affiliate, Latin American and Iberian Institute (LAII)
2026-present

Tulane University, New Orleans, Louisiana
Postdoctoral Fellow, Center for Inter-American Policy and Research (CIPR)
2024-2026

EDUCATION

University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill, North Carolina
Ph.D., Political Science, 2024
M.A., Political Science, 2020

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile, Santiago, Chile
M.A., Sociology, 2016
B.A., Sociology, 2016

PUBLICATIONS

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Jacob Gunderson. 2026. "Positional Blurring in Context: How Dimensionality and Ideology Constrain Strategy". *Perspectives on Politics*. DOI: 10.1017/S1537592726105805.

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo, and Jonathan Hartlyn. 2025. "Explaining Programmatic Party Appeals in Contemporary Latin America: The Differing Roles of Ideology, Particularism and Populism". *Party Politics*. DOI: 10.1177/13540688251409367.

de la Cerda, Nicolás. 2025. "Cueing without Parties: Experimental Evidence from Peru". *Political Behavior*. DOI: 10.1007/s11109-025-10059-x.

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Ryan Bakker, Seth Jolly, Jonathan Polk, Ruth Dassonneville, Jelle Koedam, Patrick Leslie, Jill Sheppard, and Roi Zur. 2025. "A Global Scale of Economic Left-Right Party Positions: Exploring the Cross-National and Cross-Expert Perceptions of Party Placements". *The Journal of Politics*. DOI: 10.1086/736578.

Fuller, Sam, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Jack T. Rametta. 2025. "Affect, Not Ideology: The Heterogeneous Effects of Partisan Cues on Policy Support". *Political Behavior*. DOI: 10.1007/s11109-025-10030-w.

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Jonathan Hartlyn, and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo. 2024. "Ideological and Populist Bases of Partisan Responses to the COVID-19 Pandemic in Latin America". *The Journal of Politics in Latin America*. 16(2), 252–271. DOI: 10.1177/1866802X241262326.

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Jacob Gunderson. 2024. "Are Party Families in Europe Ideologically Coherent Today?". *European Journal of Political Research*. 63(3), 1208–1226. DOI: 10.1111/1475-6765.12638.

Martínez-Gallardo, Cecilia, Nicolás de la Cerda, Jonathan Hartlyn, Ryan Bakker, Liesbet Hooghe, and Gary Marks. 2023. "Revisiting Party System Structuration in Latin America and Europe: Economic and Socio-Cultural Dimensions". *Party Politics*. 29(4), 780–792. DOI: 10.1177/13540688221090604.

de la Cerda, Nicolás. 2022. "Unstable Identities: The Decline of Partisanship in Contemporary Chile". *The Journal of Politics in Latin America*. 14(1), 3–30. DOI: 10.1177/1866802X211069378.

Bargsted, Matías and Nicolás de la Cerda. 2019. "Ideological Preferences and Evolution of the Religious Cleavage in Chile, 1998–2014". *Latin American Research Review*. 54(2), 348–365. DOI: 10.25222/larr.309.

Book Chapters

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo. 2022. "Mexico: A Politically Effective Populist Pandemic Response". In *Populists and the Pandemic: How Populists Around the World Respond to COVID-19*. Lucio Rennó and Nils Ringe, eds. Routledge. Chapter 3, pages 29–43. DOI: 10.4324/9781003197614-3.

Bargsted, Matías, Sebastián Valenzuela, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Bernardo Mackenna. 2013. "Participación ciudadana en las elecciones municipales 2012: diagnóstico y propuestas en torno al sistema de voto voluntario". In *Propuestas para Chile*. Ignacio Irarrázaval, María de los Ángeles Morandé, and Magdalena Letelier, eds. Chapter 1, pages 23–50.

Work in Progress

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Rodrigo Castro Cornejo. "Affective Clientelism: How Electoral Gift-Giving Cultivates Partisan Attachments and Electoral Support".
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at Perspectives on Politics.*

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Isabel Laterzo, and Ayelén Vanegas. "Institutional Accountability and Support for Democracy: Evidence from a Natural Experiment".
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at the British Journal of Political Science.*
– Covered in *Lawfare* (May 2025).

de la Cerda, Nicolás, Jonathan Hartlyn, Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo, and Eugenia Aguirre Raftacco. "The 2024 Chapel Hill Expert Survey – Latin America: Ideology, Populism, and Illiberalism".
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at the British Journal of Political Science.*

de la Cerda, Nicolás. "Political Identities and Belief Networks in Comparative Perspective".
– *Invited to revise and resubmit at Political Psychology.*

Argote, Pablo, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Giancarlo Visconti. "Thick and Thin Ideological Dimensions of Party Competition in Latin America".
– *Under Review.*

de la Cerda, Nicolás. "Programmatism and Blurring: A Typology of Party Appeals".

Ascencio, Sergio, Rodrigo Castro Cornejo, and Nicolás de la Cerda. "The Founder's Shadow: Party Institutionalization Under Charismatic Leadership".

Bakker, Ryan, Nicolás de la Cerda, and Jonathan Polk. "Evaluating the Trade-offs in Expert Survey Sample Size".

Cohen, Mollie J. and Nicolás de la Cerda. "Irregularity Accusations, Social Norms, and Electoral Perceptions in Peru".

de la Cerda, Nicolás. "Beyond Partisanship: Theory and Methods".

de la Cerda, Nicolás and Michael Greenberger. "The Institutions in Our Heads: Prototypes and Trust in Political Institutions".

Data Collection

Chapel Hill Expert Survey – Latin America (CHES-LA)
Principal Investigator (with Jonathan Hartlyn and Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo).
Expert survey measuring party positions on ideological and non-ideological dimensions in Latin America.
– 2020-2021: Administered in 12 Latin American countries.
– 2024-2025: Administered in 18 Latin American countries.

Chapel Hill Expert Survey – United States (CHES-US)
Principal Investigator (with Ryan Bakker, Royce Carroll, Alexa Federice, and Christopher Hare).
Expert survey measuring party positions on ideological and non-ideological dimensions in the United States.
– 2026: Data collection in progress.

External Affiliations

Universidad Diego Portales, Santiago, Chile
Investigador Adjunto. Núcleo Milenio para el Estudio de la Política, Opinión Pública y Medios en Chile (MEPOP), *2025-present*

Instituto de Estudios Peruanos, Lima, Peru
Investigador Afiliado. *Summer 2022*

Awards and Scholarships

2026 – LAII Start-Up Grant. Latin American & Iberian Institute, University of New Mexico. ($2,500)
2025 – Expense Support Grant. Institute for Humane Studies, George Mason University. ($3,500)
2025 – Supporting Impactful Publications (SIP) Program. University Office of Academic Affairs and Provost, Tulane University. ($2,500)
2025 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. ($800)
2025 – Postdoctoral Fellow Travel Fund. Office of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies, Tulane University. ($1,000)
2024 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. ($600)
2024 – Stone Center Faculty/Staff Professional Travel Award. Stone Center for Latin American Studies, Tulane University. ($650)
2024 – Postdoctoral Fellow Travel Fund. Office of Graduate and Postdoctoral Studies, Tulane University. ($500)
2024 – Mellon Conference Travel Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($500)
2023 – Uhlman Fellow. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($3,275)
2023 – APSA First Generation Scholar Travel and Accessibility Grant. American Political Science Association. ($145)
2023 – Graduate Student Travel Scholarship. Midwest Political Science Association. ($500)
2022 – James W. Prothro Award for Outstanding Research, Best Graduate Student Paper. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($675)
2022 – Carolina Latinx Center Innovation Award. Carolina Latinx Center, UNC-Chapel Hill.
2022 – Mellon Dissertation Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($3,000)
2022 – Summer Research Fellowship. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($3,000)
2022 – Thomas F. Ferdinand Summer Research Fellowship. Graduate School, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($5,000)
2021 – Summer Research Collaboratory Program. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($5,000)
2020 – Graduate Research Award. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($1,500)
2020 – Uhlman Fellow. Department of Political Science, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($2,250)
2020 – Pre-dissertation Field Research Grant. Institute for the Study of the Americas, UNC-Chapel Hill. ($1,500) [Cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic]
2020 – John Frechione Award for Lodging Support. Latin American Social and Public Policy Conference (LASPP). [Cancelled due to the COVID-19 pandemic]

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association (APSA): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026.
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA): 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026.
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA): 2021, 2025, 2026.
Latin American Studies Association (LASA): 2023, 2024, 2025.
Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference (EPOV): 2025.
European Union Studies Association (EUSA): 2025.
Asociación Chilena de Ciencia Política (ACCP): 2023.
Seminario de Opinión Pública y Comportamiento Político (UC): 2024, 2025.
World Association for Public Opinion Research (WAPOR): 2015.

Invited Talks and Seminars

Universidad Carlos III de Madrid (virtual). July 2025.
Duke/UNC Political Behavior Group. April 2024.
University of Mannheim (MZES). February 2024.

Teaching Experience

University of New Mexico

Instructor

- Political Science 580: Introduction to Empirical Research (F2026)

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Instructor

- POLI 209: Analyzing Public Opinion (F2021)
- POLI 209: Analyzing Public Opinion (Summer 2021)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics (S2021)

Teaching Assistant

- IDST 128L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (S2024)
- IDST 123L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (F2023)
- IDST 113L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (S2023)
- IDST 123L: Data Literacy Lab, Caitlin Smith (F2022)
- POLI 203: Race, Innocence, and the Decline of the Death Penalty, Frank R. Baumgartner (S2022)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Rahsaan Maxwell (F2020)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Ashley Anderson (S2020)
- POLI 130: Comparative Politics, Andrew Reynolds (F2019)

Pontificia Universidad Católica de Chile

Instructor

- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March–July 2018)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March–July 2017)
- SOL 100: Sociological Paradigms (March–July 2016)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March–July 2016)
- SOL 107: Social Ethics (March–July 2015)

Teaching Assistant

- SOL 3070: Data Analysis (August–December 2015)
- SOL 3000: Design and Analysis of Social Research (March–July 2013)

Universidad Alberto Hurtado

Instructor

- Statistics II (March–July 2016)

Professional Experience

Ekhos Consulting Firm (Chile)

Research Associate March 2016 – June 2018

- Survey polling for political campaigns and private firms.
- Political campaign consultant.

Professional Service and Activity

Discipline:

Referee: *American Journal of Political Science · Journal of Politics · British Journal of Political Science · Political Behavior · Political Psychology · European Journal of Political Research · Party Politics · Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties · Political Research Quarterly · Government and Opposition · Latin American Research Review · Latin American Politics & Society · Journal of Politics in Latin America · Bulletin of Latin American Research · Canadian Journal of Latin American and Caribbean Studies · Colombia Internacional · Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy*

Latin American Studies Association (LASA): Latin American Political Institutions Section Board Council Member (2024-2026).

Department:

Speaker Series Coordinator, Center for Inter-American Policy and Research (2024-2026).

Student Representative, Political Behavior Tenure Track Assistant Professor Search Committee (2023).

Program Coordinator, Latin American Working Group, UNC (2019-2023).

Comparative Politics Subfield Representative and Comparative Working Group Organizer, UNC-Political Science Department (2022-2023).

Methods Training

Ordinary Least Squares Regression · Generalized Linear Models · Hierarchical Models · Causal Inference · Measurement Models · Machine Learning · Bayesian Models

Technical Skills

Statistical computing in `R`, Stan, Python, and Stata; LaTeX; Qualtrics

Languages

Spanish: Native
English: Fluent

References

Jonathan Hartlyn
K. J. Reckford Dist. Professor of Poli. Sci.
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
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Liesbet Hooghe
W. R. Kenan Dist. Professor of Poli. Sci.
University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
hooghe@email.unc.edu

Cecilia Martínez-Gallardo
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Ryan Bakker
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University of Sharjah
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